CSC 1301L
Lab for Principles of Computer Science I

Fall 2026
Course Information & Syllabus

Instructor: Prakash Chourasia
Office Location: 1 Park Place, Suite 956, Atlanta, GA
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Office Hours: Wed 11:00 AM – 2:00 PM or Virtual Meetings only by appointment

Lab Grader GTA: Aakrit Sharma Lamsal
Office Location: 1 Park Place, Suite 956, Atlanta, GA
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Office Hours: M-W 12:30 – 2:30 PM

Course Description
This course is the companion laboratory component of CSC 1301 Principles of Computer Science I. The lab session provides hands-on instruction in writing Python programs to tackle questions inspired by real-world problems. Students will learn to implement programming fundamentals, including variables, data types, operators, flow control, functions, and modules.

Course Outcomes

Students will be able to:

1. Write clear and concise Python code.
2. Use Python to solve a variety of problems.
3. Debug and troubleshoot Python code.
4. Use Python libraries and modules.

Textbook:

1. None Required

Grade Distribution

Item	% of Final Grade
Quizzes	15%
Weekly Assignments	40%
Exams (x3)	45%

Tentative Course Schedule

Week of	Lab Session Topic
Aug 24	Introduction to Python 3 and IDEs
Aug 31	Variables and Expressions
Sep 07	Basic Data Types
Sep 14	Branching
Sep 21	Loops
Sep 28	**Exam 1 (80% submission, 20% oral Exam)**
Oct 05	Functions & Strings
Oct 12	Lists
Oct 19	Dictionaries
Oct 26	**Exam 2 (70% submission, 30% oral Exam)**
Nov 02	Classes
Nov 09	Exceptions
Nov 16	Modules, File I/O
Nov 23	[Thanksgiving Break] No Class
Nov 30	**Final Exam (60% submission, 40% oral Exam)**
Dec 07	[Finals Week] No Class

Note: Topic dates are subject to change.

Important Dates

- First day of class – August 24th - 28th
- Drop deadline – August 28th at 5 pm
- **Exam 1 – Week of Sept 28th**
- Withdrawal deadline – October 13th
- **Exam 2 – Nov 2 to Nov 6 (Regular Lab Hours)**
- Thanksgiving Break – November 24th to November 29th
- **Final Exam – Nov 30 to Dec 4 (Regular Lab Hours)**

Course Policies

Weekly Assignment & Quiz
This course includes weekly lab sessions, during which you will get hands-on practical exercises on the topics covered in the previous week's lecture of the companion course, CSC 1301. Each lab session includes a lab quiz and a lab assignment.

Assignments - Oral Assessment
You will be called for an oral assessment of the assignment 2-3 times in the whole semester. You will receive an email from me to come to my office hours listed in the syllabus. If you do not attend or are a no-show, you will receive a 0 for that assignment.

During the assessment, you will be asked to **explain the assignment you completed that week**, including how your code works and the reasoning behind your solution. You may also be asked follow-up questions to demonstrate your understanding of your work.

Attendance is required when selected. If you fail to attend the scheduled assessment without prior communication or an approved arrangement, you will **receive a grade of 0 for that assignment**. The purpose of the oral assessment is to verify that you understand and can explain the work you submitted.

Submission
Quizzes will be assigned on iCollege and must be completed at the start of the lab session. Turn in assignments electronically on iCollege by the end of the day. They may be accepted one day later with a 15% penalty.

Attendance Policy
Lab sessions are held in person, and attendance is mandatory for all students. Credit will not be given for remotely submitted assignments or quizzes. Complete the Professor Absence Notification with the Dean of Students at this link if you experience an emergency that forces you to miss multiple lab sessions.

Exams
This course has three exams (coding + oral assessment). Because the exam dates are announced in advance, no make-up exams for unexcused absences. **For each exam there will be Oral assessment.**

Oral Assessment - You must schedule an appointment for an oral assessment within a week of the exam (I will provide a link to schedule an appointment during office hours).
During the oral assessment, you will be asked to **explain the exam solution submitted**, including how your code works and the reasoning behind your solution. You may also be asked follow-up questions to demonstrate your understanding of your work.

What are office hours?
Office hours are times an instructor (or TA) sets aside to be available so students can stop by and discuss anything about the course. Office hours are held only during the regular semester (i.e., not during the

week of final exams or between semesters). You don't need to make an appointment to attend the pre-scheduled office hours (unless the syllabus or in-class instructions say otherwise). If my door is closed, please knock; this usually means I'm talking with someone about a private matter.

Office Hours
Office hours may be held in person or virtually through WebEx outside the listed hours. My pre-scheduled office hours will be held in person during the abovementioned time. To schedule an in-person appointment outside these hours, contact me with at least three suggested dates and times when you can meet and whether you want to meet in person.

Office hours may be canceled occasionally because of meetings, seminars, talks, conferences, etc. If I must cancel my office hours, I will post an iCollege announcement.

Communication
Please communicate primarily via email at ***pchourasia1@gsu.edu***. **DO NOT use the iCollege internal mailing system.** Messages sent to me using the iCollege internal mailing system will be forwarded to my GSU email, but you will receive the response at *your@student.gsu.edu* email address. **Include the course number, CSC 1301L, and your Lab time, e.g., (Fri 9:00 AM - 10:40 AM), in the subject line** so I can differentiate between classes. If you have a grading issue, please contact your assigned grader first. However, you can always speak with me during office hours.

Americans with Disabilities Act
"Students who wish to request accommodation for a disability may do so by registering with the Access and Accommodation Center. Students may be accommodated only after the Access and Accommodation Center issues a signed **Accommodation Plan** and are responsible for providing a copy of that plan to instructors of all classes in which accommodation is sought.

Academic Dishonesty
All work, including homework, programming assignments, and exams, should be your sole work. **You should not work with other students on shared program solutions or use program solutions found on the Internet. Specifically, you should never copy someone else's solution or code and never let a classmate examine your code.** If you have trouble with an assignment, please consult me or a TA.

You can find GSU's code of conduct for academic dishonesty at this link. If you are caught cheating or plagiarizing, you will receive an immediate and final grade of 'F' and will be reported to the Dean of Students. All parties will be treated equally; therefore, I will not differentiate between the student who copies the solution and the student who provides it.

Artificial Intelligence Statement
You cannot use generative AI tools like ChatGPT for any graded work in this course, including lab assignments. Prohibited AI use includes idea or text generation, writing or revising your work, developing media assets, or data analysis and presentation. You may use a generative AI tool like ChatGPT only when it is expressly permitted as part of an assignment.

Note: The content of this Syllabus is tentative and subject to change during the semester.